

Content Supply Chain: Activate Offering Toolkit

UPDATED: MARCH 2026

YOUR 1-PAGE SUMMARY

GTM HUB PAGE 

This [link](#) has all the content to support the offering: training, engagement models, case studies, thought leadership, Merkle reports, etc.

Content Supply Chain: Activate

WHAT IT IS

The **Content Supply Chain Activate** offering transforms platform investments into continuous value drivers for enterprises struggling with adoption, inefficient workflows, and suboptimal performance. Through strategic change management and workforce enablement, the offering:

- Ensures enterprise-wide adoption
- Optimizes AI-powered automation and agentic capabilities
- Continuously adapts as technologies evolve

It closes the critical gap between implementation and value realization through sustained optimization.

CSC Activate is where IT and marketing leaders partner to maximize platform value.

KEY BUSINESS OUTCOMES

Accelerated ROI Through Adoption

85% ROI on tech investments

Organizations implementing three or more digital adoption best practices achieve **85% ROI on their technology investments**, compared to just 22% for those without structured adoption strategies.

Continuous AI Optimization

50% reduction in time-to-proficiency

Organizations actively optimizing AI-powered automation and agentic content production report **70% higher ROI**, while **reducing** time-to-proficiency **by 50%** as technologies evolve.

Revenue Growth Enablement

10-15% revenue uplift

Improve personalization at scale, **driving 10-15% uplift** in revenue and conversion rates.

WEDGE

Platform Value Realization
3-8 months

Investment: \$400k-800k USD

A rescue program where some version of a supply chain is operating and the client is looking for help to run it.

ENGAGEMENTS

Continuous Value Accelerator
1-3+ years

Investment: \$1.0M-2M+ USD

Anchored with a PMO, this scaled engagement focuses on realizing value for the long term, optimizing a solid supply chain implementation and doubling down on continuous process improvement.

Managed Content Production

Investment: TBD

A x-dentsu (DC, Tag, Media) engagement for clients looking to completely outsource their content supply chain.

KEY CAPABILITIES

Engagements pull together these capabilities as client need state demands.

- Enablement & Adoption
- Content Optimization
- Managed Services

What's Inside

PART 1:

POV and Narrative

EXTERNAL



[LINK](#)

PART 2:

Case Studies and Why Merkle

EXTERNAL

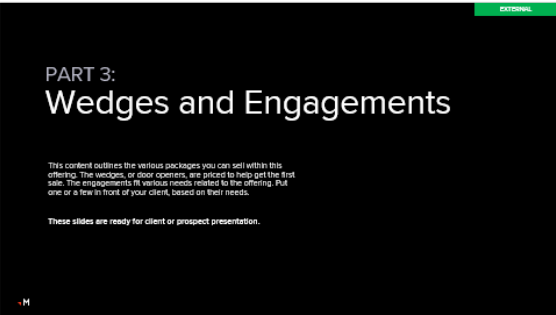


[LINK](#)

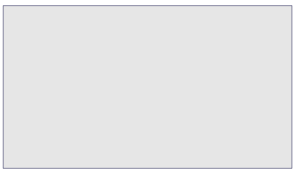
PART 3:

Wedges and Engagements

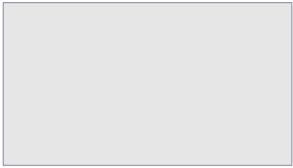
EXTERNAL



[LINK](#)



[LINK](#)

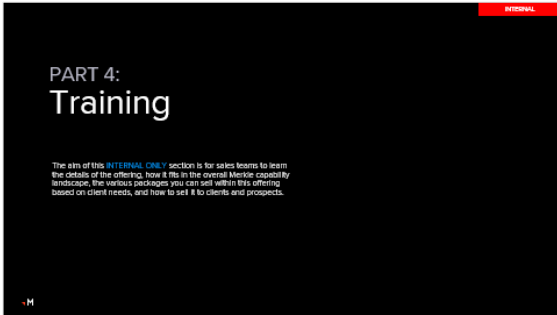


[LINK](#)

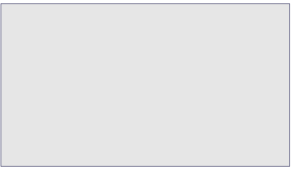
PART 4:

Training

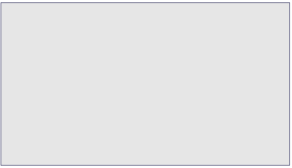
INTERNAL



[LINK](#)



[LINK](#)



[LINK](#)

PART 1: POV and Narrative

These slides include content that supports the offering narrative. It includes problem space definition, predictions or expectations on how the market will develop, supporting market research, the opportunity space, and our unique POV or approach to solving the problem.

These slides are ready for client or prospect presentation.

Merkle's ACTIVATE approach

Closing the value realization gap

Enterprises invest heavily in content technology but struggle with adoption, inefficient workflows, and suboptimal performance. Technology alone does not deliver value; activated people and optimized processes do.

The Merkle difference

Enterprise-Wide Adoption Programs: Drive platform utilization from under 40% to over 70% within 90 days through role-based enablement and embedded training.

AI-Powered Automation Optimization: By 2028, organizations optimizing AI automation will report 70%+ higher ROI and 50% faster time to proficiency.

Partnership for Value Realization: We stay beyond deployment because the hardest work happens after go-live. Foster collaboration between IT and marketing to maximize platform value.

Measurable Business Outcomes: Improved personalization will drive 10-15% revenue uplift through 2030. Track accelerated ROI, adoption rates, and conversion improvements.

The ACTIVATE offering portfolio

- Platform Value Realization (12 weeks)
- Continuous Value Accelerator (6-24 months)
- Managed Content Services (dentsu agency model)

PART 2:

Case Studies and Why Merkle

This content provides reasons to believe that we are uniquely qualified to solve the client challenge presented in the preceding narrative.

Case studies should only be presented under NDA. If no NDA exists, the case studies should be blinded.

These slides are ready for client or prospect presentation.

B2B TECH AND OPERATING STRATEGY

Drive transformation through an adaptive end-to-end Content Supply Chain Solution

BUSINESS CHALLENGE

Fragmented tools and manual processes slowed content delivery and limited efficient collaboration across global client and agency of record teams.

MERKLE SOLUTION

We integrated Adobe's marketing technology stack to create GenStudio dentsu+, a unified content supply chain solution. Merkle's comprehensive discovery uncovered 110 optimization opportunities, with 35% addressable through technology and proposed an integrated workflow ecosystem and roadmap to eliminate manual handoffs and enable scalable content production with built-in governance and measurement.

THE WORK

- Launched a Future State Architect Design connecting Workfront, AEM, DI Studio, Firefly, Creative Cloud, Figma and distribution platforms
- Established metadata taxonomy and content organization framework with established governance policies for assets ownership and workflows
- Built 12 AI powered creative automations, WF-to-WF, Workfront-to-AEM, Dropbox, and to DI-Studio integrations for scaled asset production
- Delivered Customer Journey Analytics proof-of-concept, enabling end-to-end content performance measurement
- Created a Change Management and Adoption Plan, with identified Champions, roadmap and support infrastructure

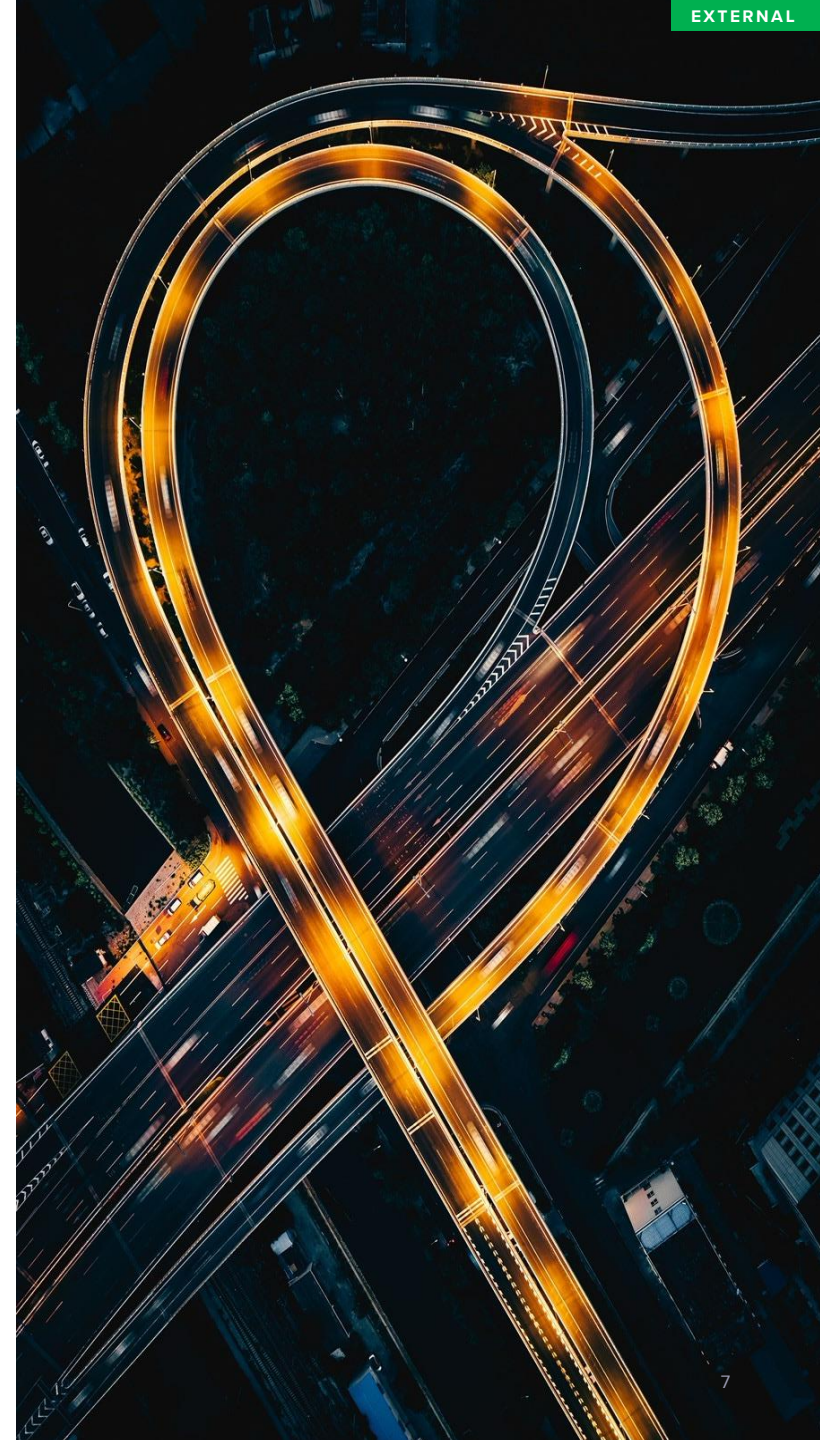
UPON IMPLEMENTATION RESULTS

**\$3.3M Projected
Annual Savings**

**82% Efficiency Gained
Per Campaign**

**Integrated Adobe and
dentsu innovations**

**Reimagined content
creation and visibility**



Why Merkle



We power the experience economy.

\$35B+

annual GMV on Merkle-built experiences and apps

\$20B+

annual GMV optimized by digital shelf, business management services, and merchandising analytics

650M+

Loyalty members enrolled in managed programs

25,000+

CRM, ABX (B2B) and promotional campaigns deployed annually

70B+

Chats and emails sent annually with 99.9% accuracy



Our capabilities

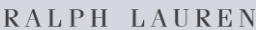
EXPERIENCE & PRODUCT INNOVATION



ENGAGEMENT & LOYALTY



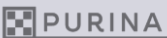
PLATFORMS & ENGINEERING



ANALYTICS & INSIGHTS



CONSULTING & BUSINESS OPERATIONS



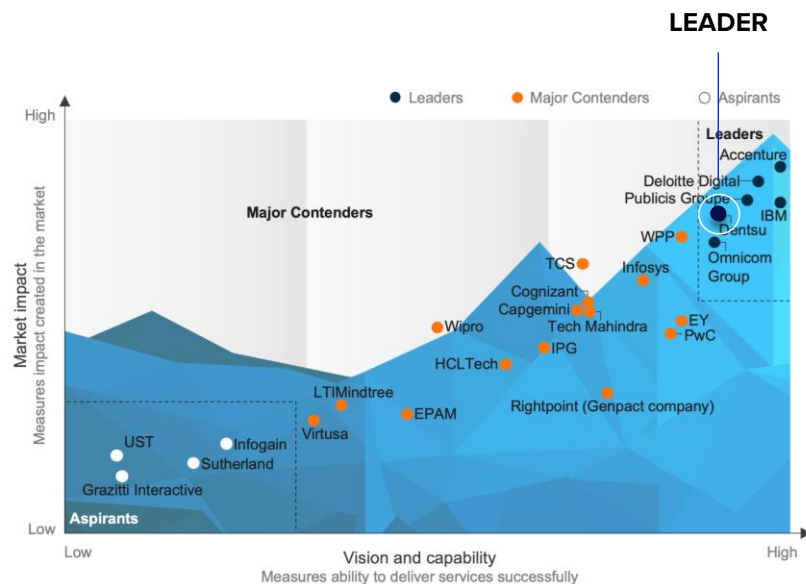
A world-leading transformation consultancy.



Everest Group
PEAK Matrix for
Adobe Services
2025



Everest Group
PEAK Matrix for
Content Supply Chain Services
2024



Global Experience Build MarketScape
Leader
Q4 2023

Customer Data Strategy & Activation
Leader
Q2 2022

Customer Database & Engagement Agencies
Leader
Q2 2022



Magic Quadrant™ for Digital Experience Services Report
Named “a Leader”
2024



Adobe Experience Cloud Professional Services MarketScape Report
Leader
2024

Data Clean Room Technology for Advertising and Marketing Use Cases
Named “a Major Player”
2025



Excellence in AI Strategy Consulting
2023



People’s Voice Award Winner Apps, dApps and Software, Creative Production
Q4 2023



Preferred partners with **the best of the best.**

10,000+
Salesforce certifications –
#1 Global agency partner

STRATEGIC ALLIANCES



1,300+
Adobe certifications –
#1 partner with the most global
Adobe product specializations

ALL ALLIANCES

COMMERCE salesforce SAP VTEX MIRAKL Adobe Commerce Cloud MARKETPLACER shopifyplus BIGCOMMERCE	CONTENT Adobe Experience Manager Drupal™ Amplience SITECORE contentful magnolia Optimizely	ENGAGEMENT & CAMPAIGN salesforce Adobe KLAVIYO braze Google MessageGears attentive	DATA PLATFORMS ActionIQ TEALIUM mparticle bloomreach
LOYALTY salesforce Meta yotpo. LoyaltyPlus Clutch braze	A.I. & BIG DATA Adobe Einstein Azure Google Cloud databricks snowflake	EXPERIENCE INNOVATION UNREAL ENGINE unity Figma NVIDIA Meta Microsoft android ROBLOX	ASSETS & FEEDS Cloudinary SALSIFY feedonomics

1,000+
Google GA and GCP
certified specialists

PART 3:

Wedges and Engagements

This content outlines the various packages you can sell within this offering. The wedges, or door openers, are priced to help get the first sale. The engagements fit various needs related to the offering. Put one or a few in front of your client, based on their needs.

These slides are ready for client or prospect presentation.

WHAT ARE WE SELLING?

Merkle's CSC Activate Engagements

ACTIVATE

Who: Enterprises operating a modern content ecosystem & not realizing desired value

What: Optimize a brand's content continuum with closed-loop insights & managed services

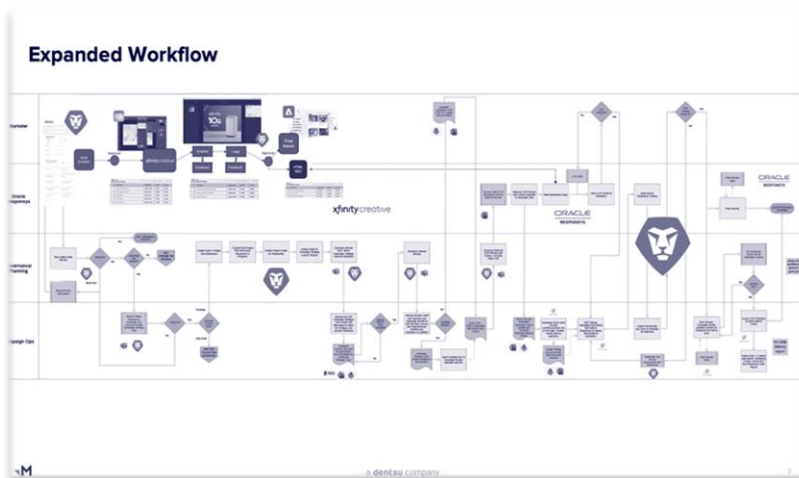
Why: Ensure enterprise's CSC evolves at the speed of automation, ai, and agentic capabilities

Strategy	Strategy
DX	DX
Analytics & Insights	Analytics & Insights
COE Program Management	COE Program Management
WEDGE Platform Value Realization	ENGAGEMENT Continuous Value Accelerator
Optimize in-process program for closed-loop measurement & enterprise adoption	Anchored with a PMO, this is CSC Run & Optimize
3-8 Months Investment: \$400-800k	2-5 Years \$5M/year
SVP/VP Mktg Ops, Tech Ops	CEO, CMO, CTO
Adoption barrier diagnostic	Enterprise Adoption Program
Current State Workflow	Continuous Optimization Roadmap
Embedded enablement opportunities	Performance Analytics Dashboard
Governance framework	AI Enhancement Plan
Platform champion training	Knowledge Transfer Documentation
Stabilization metrics dashboard (BVA)	

WEDGE

Platform Value Realization

YOUR CLIENT-FACING 1-PAGE SUMMARIES LOOK LIKE THESE



SUPPORTING NARRATIVE

Platform Value Realization

The Hidden Crisis

Most enterprise content platform "successes" are actually failures in disguise. Systems go live, implementations are declared complete, and teams are expected to adapt—but they don't and scale remains a fantasy. Only 28% of employees can effectively use their organization's AI tools ([WalkMe](#)), and the same pattern repeats across DAMs, MAMs, and workflow platforms. Teams quietly revert to familiar processes, leaving multi-million-dollar investments collecting digital dust. Platforms can't deliver content velocity when teams bypass them entirely.

Why Traditional Support Fails

Standard vendor support addresses technical issues, not human ones. Help desks fix bugs but can't fix adoption. Training sessions teach features but don't change behaviors. Without embedded support that meets teams where they work, expensive platforms may work technically but fail operationally. With fragmented workflows, unclear governance, and missing metadata prevent scale and platforms become expensive shelfware.

The Merkle Difference

Platform Value Realization isn't traditional consulting—it's operational rescue and scale preparation. We embed within client teams, identifying why adoption stalled and systematically removing barriers. Our approach combines technical reconfiguration with behavioral change, ensuring both systems and people perform optimally, recovering stranded platform impact and opportunity for operational capacity.

Real Impact in Action

A global CPG client saw their \$2M DAM investment sitting at 35% utilization six months post-launch. Creative teams were still using shared drives, brand managers couldn't find approved assets, and regional offices operated in silos. Within 60 days of Merkle intervention, utilization jumped to 72%. Asset search time dropped from 45 minutes to under 5 minutes. Duplicate content creation fell by 60%. The platform finally delivered the ROI they'd projected two years earlier.

OVERVIEW

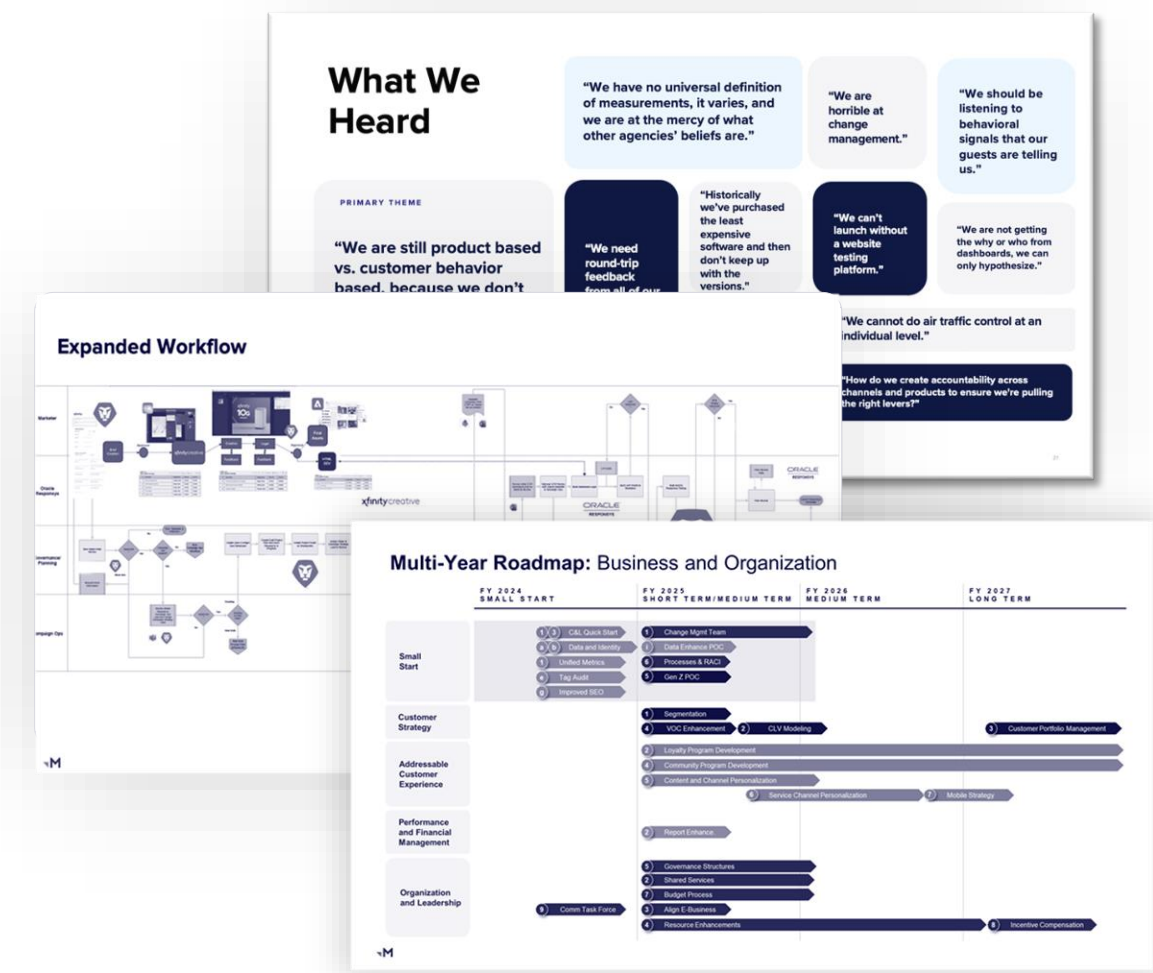
Platform Value Realization

Stabilize operations and protect your content platform investment fast.

Your content platforms are live, but teams have reverted to manual processes and workarounds. Platform Value Realization addresses the critical gap between implementation and value realization. Merkle stabilizes operations by diagnosing adoption barriers, reconfiguring workflows, and delivering embedded enablement that builds team confidence. We establish governance structures that prevent regression and sustain performance. Organizations typically see platform utilization increase from under 40% to over 70% within 90 days.

INCLUDES

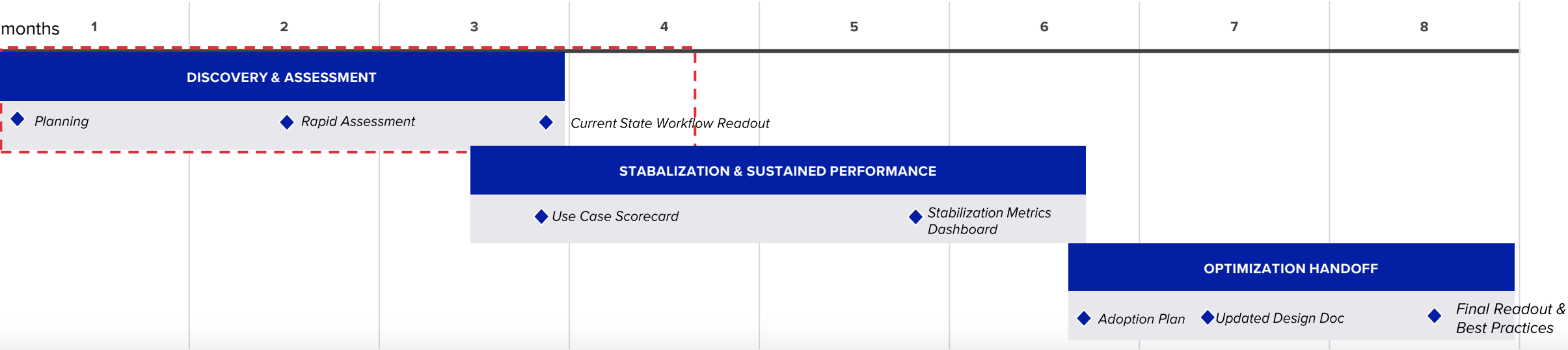
- Adoption barrier diagnostic
- Current State Workflow
- Embedded enablement opportunities
- Governance framework
- Platform champion training
- Stabilization metrics dashboard (BVA)



EXAMPLE DELIVERABLES

Platform Value Realization - GOLD

Timeline may be adjusted for assessments of externally developed environments, and Level of engagement by Merkle.
Bronze = 3 months
Silver = 6 months



RAPID ASSESSMENT

1-3 months

Baseline the hurdles

- Adoption barrier diagnostic across all user groups
- Current workflow analysis and pain point identification
- Stakeholder interviews and system utilization audit
- Platform champion identification and initial engagement

STABILIZATION SPRINT

2-4 months

Recover and enable

- Workflow reconfiguration and quick-win adjustments (no new platform integrations*)
- Embedded enablement program launch within teams
- Platform champion intensive training and certification recs
- Governance framework adjustment and role clarification (Redrive RACI)

SUSTAINED PERFORMANCE

2-4 months

Operationalize and monitor metrics

- Stabilization metrics dashboard deployment and monitoring
- Use case health scorecard
- Advanced user training and capability building with recorded artifacts
- Process refinement based on early performance data
- Regression prevention protocols and ongoing support structure

HANDOFF & OPTIMIZATION PLAN

2-3 months

Realize value and evaluate scale-readiness

- Performance validation and success metrics confirmation
- Documentation and runbook transfer to internal teams
- Prioritized Implementation development for future improvements
- Transition planning for potential continuous engagement

Investment: \$880K+
Timing: 8-10 months

- Outcomes:**
- Restored operational stability
 - Reduced workflow bottlenecks
 - Increased platform adoption
 - Demonstrated measurable ROI

PACKAGED ENGAGEMENT

Continuous Value Accelerator

YOUR CLIENT-FACING 1-PAGE SUMMARIES LOOK LIKE THESE

GTM team to add slide thumbnails

SUPPORTING NARRATIVE

Continuous Value Accelerator



The Strategic Reality

Organizations with specialist support achieve 196% ROI versus 30% for those going it alone [[Mordor Intelligence](#)]¹—but the real advantage comes from compounding returns over time. Static content platforms become competitive liabilities; continuously optimized ones become market differentiators.

Why PMO-Anchored Approach Works

Content operations span multiple departments, technologies, and objectives. Without dedicated governance and measurement rigor, optimization efforts fail to scale across complex enterprises. A PMO provides the authority and strategic perspective needed to drive sustainable, enterprise-wide transformation.

The AI Imperative

75% of businesses have adopted AI [[G2](#)], but platforms must continuously evolve to leverage emerging capabilities—from automated workflows to predictive content intelligence. Organizations without optimization frameworks get locked into yesterday's capabilities while competitors advance.

Proven Results

A global technology client reduced content production time by 65%, improved asset reuse by 80%, and generated \$4.2M annual savings through continuous optimization—with ROI continuing to compound as insights feed back into strategic decisions.

OVERVIEW

Continuous Value Accelerator

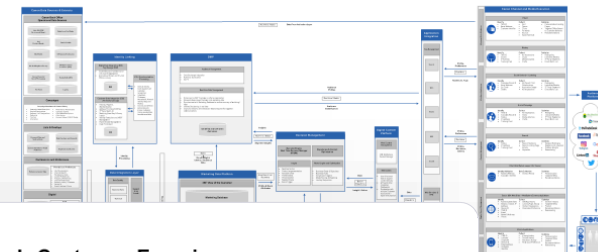
Transform Platform Investment into Competitive Advantage

Anchored by a dedicated PMO, this enterprise-scale engagement transforms content operations into a strategic business differentiator across multiple markets and business units. Organizations with specialist support achieve 196% ROI versus 30% for those going it alone [Mordor Intelligence], with compounding returns delivering 40-60% content velocity improvements and 70%+ asset reuse gains over three years. Our closed-loop measurement and AI-ready optimization ensures platforms continuously adapt with emerging technologies, turning content capabilities into sustained competitive advantage.

INCLUDES

- Enterprise Adoption Program
- Continuous Optimization Roadmap
- PMO Governance Framework
- Performance Analytics Dashboard
- AI Enhancement Plan
- Knowledge Transfer Documentation

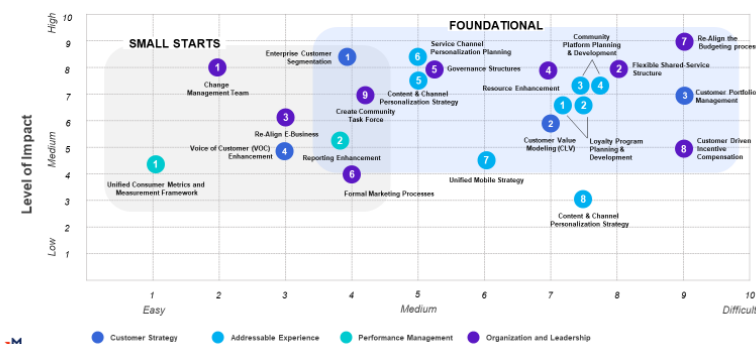
Future State Blueprint



Illustrative Use Case: Multi-touch Customer Experience

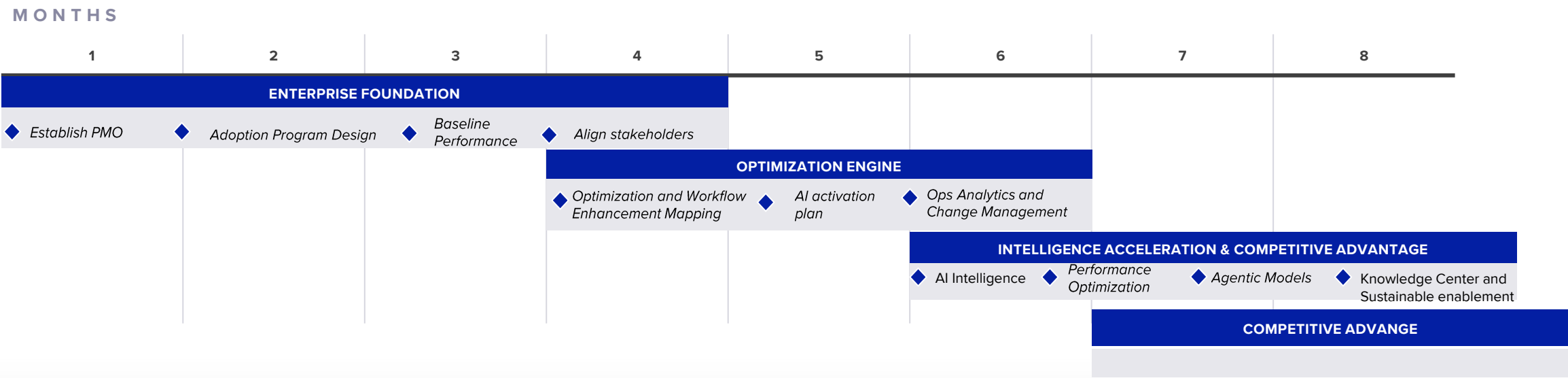


Business and Organizational Recommendations Were Plotted on a Scale of Level of Impact vs. Level of Effort



EXAMPLE DELIVERABLES

Continuous Value Accelerator – GOLD



ENTERPRISE FOUNDATION

1-4 Months

Building blocks

- PMO establishment and governance framework deployment
- Enterprise adoption program design across all markets/business units
- Baseline performance measurement and analytics dashboard setup
- Stakeholder alignment and success metrics definition across enterprise

OPTIMIZATION ENGINE

5-12 Months

Optimized path

- Continuous optimization roadmap execution and workflow enhancement
- AI enhancement plan implementation and capability activation
- Performance analytics dashboard operationalization and insights generation
- Cross-functional training and change management at scale

INTELLIGENCE & ACCELERATION

13-24 Months

Automations and AI Introduction

- Advanced AI-driven content intelligence and predictive capabilities
- Closed-loop measurement integration feeding strategic content decisions
- 40-60% content velocity improvements and workflow acceleration
- Performance optimization based on real-time data and market feedback

COMPETITIVE ADVANTAGE

25-36 Months

Exponential Scale

- Agentic models optimized
- 70%+ asset reuse gains and enterprise-wide scaling
- Knowledge transfer documentation and internal capability building
- Strategic content operations transformation into market differentiator
- Sustained competitive advantage through continuous adaptation

Investment: \$1,080,000+

Timing: 9-12 Months

Outcomes:

- Healthy and sustainable PMO practices and Knowledge centers
- AI enabled and delivering value
- Systems connected and healthy
- Proactive, data enabled and AI powered optimizations
- Governance practices established for both practices and platforms

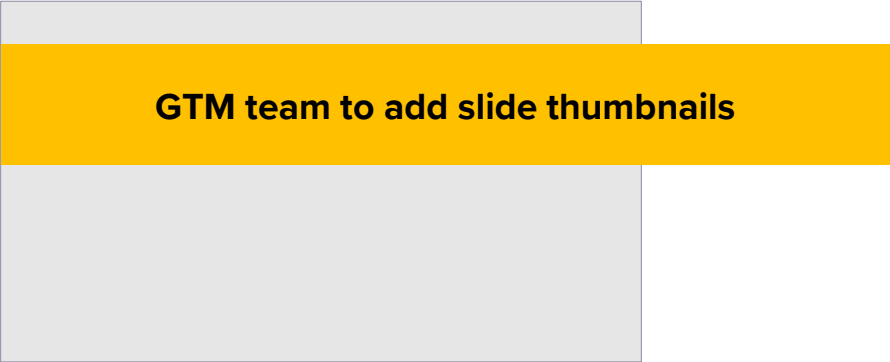
Cross-Phase Activities (Ongoing)

- 🏠 Monthly PMO governance reviews and strategic alignment
- 📅 Quarterly Optimization and tech evolution assessment
- 🗣️ Performance monitoring and benchmarking
- 🔮 Emerging future-proofing tech integrations

PACKAGED ENGAGEMENT

Managed Content Production

YOUR CLIENT-FACING 1-PAGE SUMMARIES LOOK LIKE THESE



GTM team to add slide thumbnails

OVERVIEW

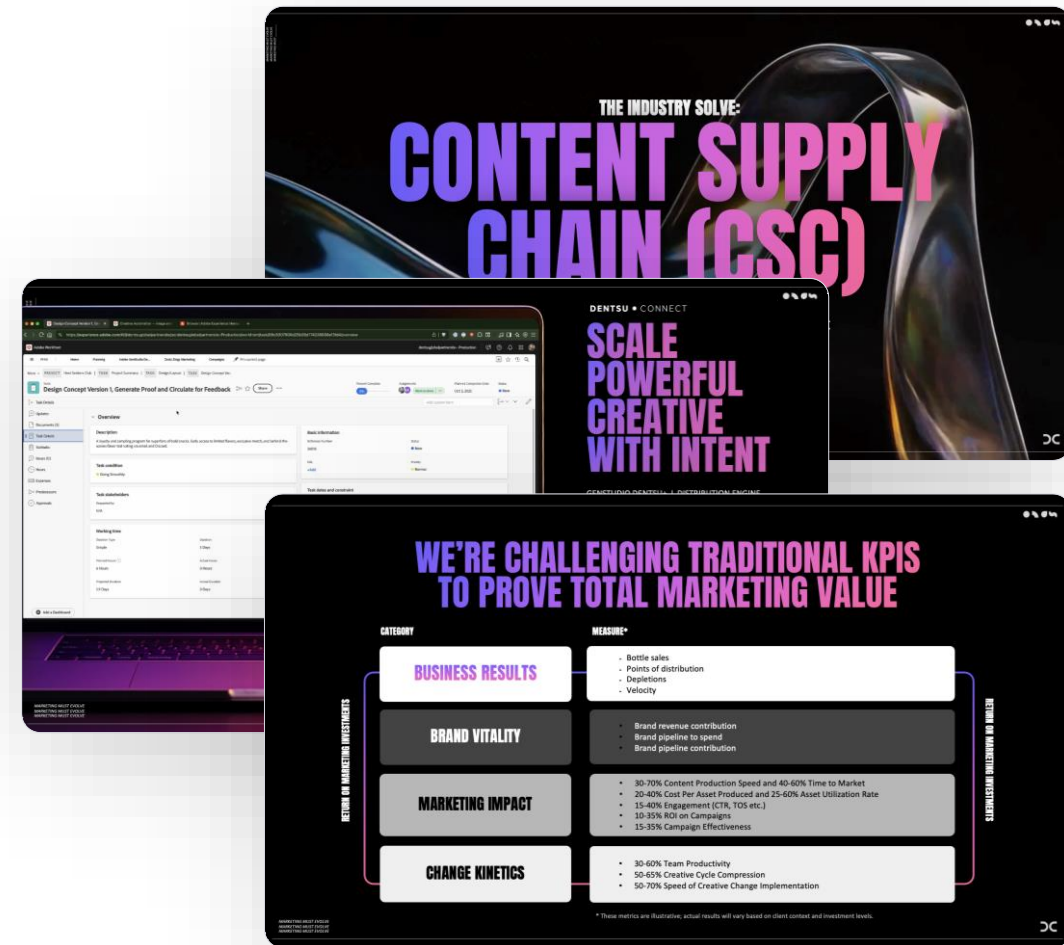
Managed Content Production

Turn Content Into a Competitive Advantage Without the Operational Burden

Some organizations recognize that content operations excellence requires capabilities beyond their strategic focus. Managed Content Production provides a complete outsourced solution through Dentsu's integrated creative, production, and media network, combining AI-accelerated workflows, global transcreation expertise, and performance-driven optimization. The engagement transforms content from operational challenge into market differentiator, powered by GenStudio dentsu+, the first agency ecosystem built on Adobe's platform.

INCLUDES

- Full-service content production and creative operations
- GenStudio dentsu+ AI-powered production ecosystem
- Multi-market transcreation and localization
- Omnichannel asset adaptation and versioning
- Real-time compliance and brand governance
- Content performance analytics and optimization



EXAMPLE DELIVERABLES

PART 4: Training

The aim of this **INTERNAL ONLY** section is for sales teams to learn the details of the offering, how it fits in the overall Merkle capability landscape, the various packages you can sell within this offering based on client needs, and how to sell it to clients and prospects.

Market Contacts

AMER



Michelle Cascone
VP, Growth Architect



Ed Forman
Chief Growth Architect

EMEA



Nicholas Burcher
Adobe EMEA
Alliances Director



Billy Hanna
Adobe UK Alliances
Director

Complete the Content Supply Chain Diagnostic

An interactive 45-question diagnostic that evaluates client content operations across five core areas on a 1 to 5 scale:

- 1. Creation and Production
- 2. Workflow and Planning
- 3. Asset Management
- 4. Delivery and Activation
- 5. Data, Reporting, and Insights

Goals:

- Establish quantitative baseline of current capabilities
- Identify operational gaps
- Prioritize improvement initiatives



HEALTH CHECK DELIVERABLES

Current State v. Industry Benchmark Report

Data-Driven Business Case

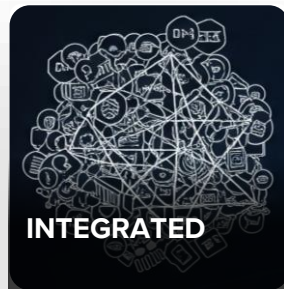
MATURITY LEVEL SCORES



DEFINED

Score
1.0 – 1.9

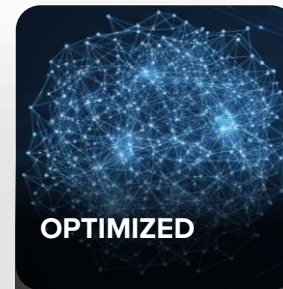
Siloed teams, manual work and reactive / chaotic approach to content. Reliance on tools like excel, email and WeTransfer to manage content.



INTEGRATED

Score
2.0 – 2.9

Tools like DAMs and project management may be used, but other workflows are manual and limited connections between content, experience and media teams.



OPTIMIZED

Score
3.0 – 3.9

Connected teams with integrated tech, working to common objectives and measuring against standardized KPIs.



INNOVATIVE

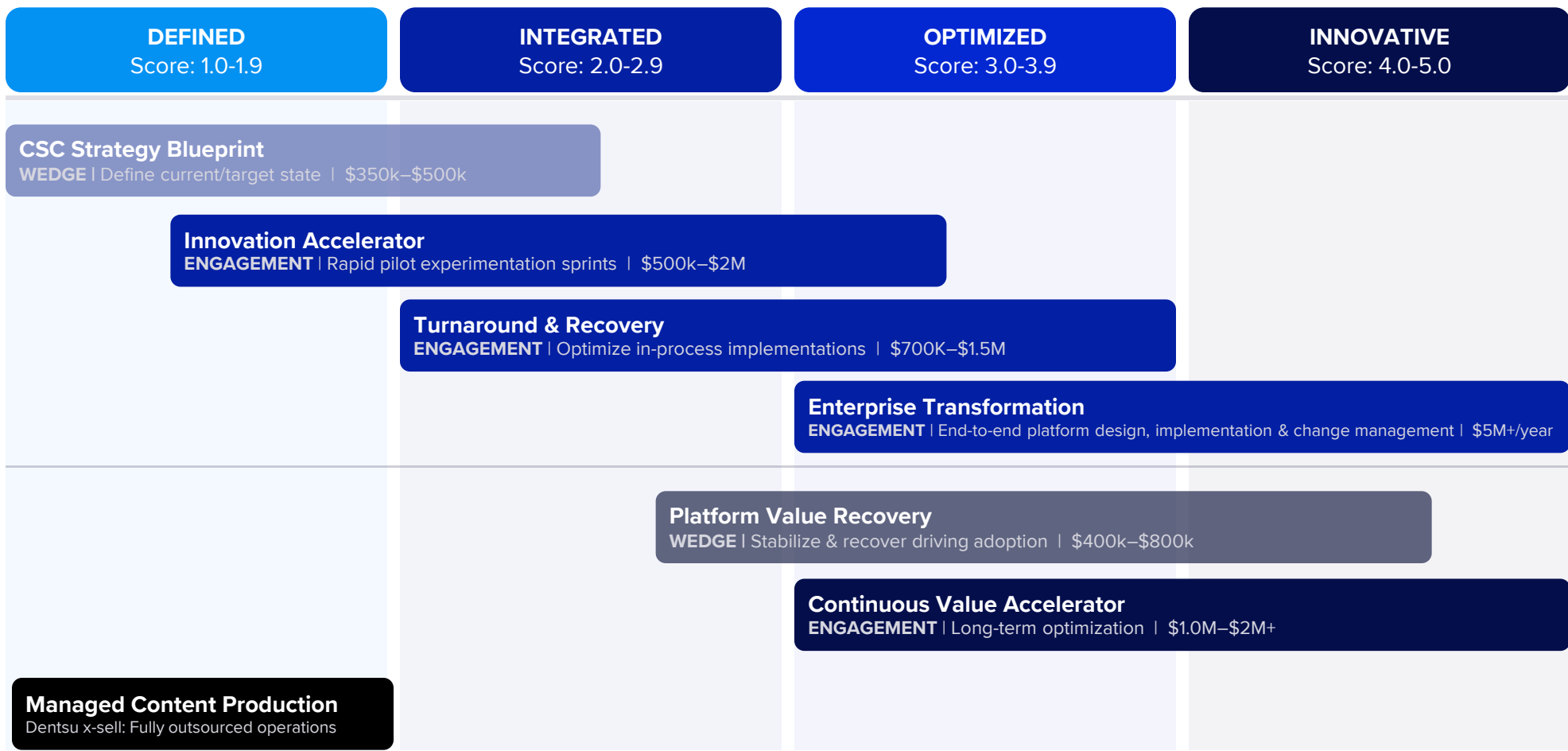
Score
4.0 – 5.0

Fully connected and integrated teams across markets, powered by data, tech and intelligence, with more and more work being done by AI agents.

CSC Diagnostic scores Mapped to Build and Activate Offerings

Build
Move a client from blueprint to enterprise transformation with engagements to prove value along the way.

Activate
Designed to take a client's CSC build from enterprise adoption to run & optimize managed services.



Client Journey: **BUILD** → **ACTIVATE** Cross-sell once Build stabilizes

YOUR 1-PAGE SUMMARY

CONTENT SUPPLY CHAIN: ACTIVATE

Platform Value Realization

BUSINESS CHALLENGES

- Stalled platform adoption and utilization
- Overburdened teams managing daily operations
- Unclear governance slowing content velocity

OBJECTIVE

Focuses on stabilizing existing supply chains when teams lack bandwidth, providing immediate operational support with governance, and delivering quick wins that create foundation for future work.

FOLLOW-ON ENGAGEMENTS

- Enterprise Transformation (Build)
- Continuous Value Accelerator (Activate)

CLIENT

xx

APPROACH

- Conduct operational health assessment
- Deploy trained resources for execution
- Establish governance and workflow standards
- Implement user enablement and training

DELIVERABLES

- Current state workflow & heatmap
- Use Case Scorecard
- Stabilization Checklist
- Training Guides
- Governance Model

MERKLE PRODUCTS AND IP

- CSC Framework and Maturity Models

Investment: \$350,000+
Timing: 8-10 months

- Outcomes:**
- Restored operational stability
 - Increased platform adoption
 - Reduced workflow bottlenecks
 - Demonstrated measurable ROI

YOUR 1-PAGE SUMMARY

CONTENT SUPPLY CHAIN: ACTIVATE

Continuous Value Accelerator

BUSINESS CHALLENGES

Unclear ROI from platform investment
Platform AI and automation underutilized
Closed-loop insights siloed from creative planning

OBJECTIVE

Deliver long-term platform value through a PMO-led engagement that activates emerging AI and automation, continuously refines Build.Buy.Borrow strategy, and drives performance-driven insights directly into creative briefs and content decisions.

FOLLOW-ON ENGAGEMENTS

COE Development
Operationa Handoff & Knowledge Transfer
Strategic Advisory Retention
Managed Service Transition (Alt. Path)

CLIENT

APPROACH AND DELIVERABLES

- Build.Buy.Borrow strategy refinement
- AI and agent capability activation
- Continuous process optimization
- Closed-loop measurement framework
- Performance insights to briefing
- Ongoing value and ROI tracking

MERKLE PRODUCTS AND IP

- Enterprise adoption program
- AI-powered Performance analytics
- PMO governance framework with global standardization
- AI enhancement plan
- Multi-year optimization strategy
- COE and governance guidance

Investment: \$1,080,000 – 1,440,000

Timing: 9-12 months

Outcomes:

- Platform value compounding over time
- AI and agent capabilities operationalized
- Creative planning informed by performance data
- Clear, trackable ROI from investment



Buyers and Industries

Understand our buyer and their motivation as well as the outcomes we deliver that help them meet their goals. Dive into industry-specific considerations.

PRIMARY AUDIENCE

CEO/CTO/CMO

C-suite executives who have already invested in content platforms but are not seeing the expected returns. They face pressure to demonstrate ROI from existing technology spend while expensive platforms sit underutilized and teams revert to manual workarounds.

Concern #1

Platform underutilization

Significant platform investments deliver only 35% of projected ROI because teams have not adopted new workflows and continue using legacy processes.

Concern #2

Stalled adoption

Change fatigue and inadequate enablement result in low platform adoption rates, with users abandoning new tools within weeks of launch.

Concern #3

Inability to prove value

Leadership cannot demonstrate clear ROI from technology investments, making it difficult to justify continued funding or expansion.

PRIMARY OUTCOMES

CSC Activate transforms existing content platform investments into continuous value drivers. Through strategic change management, workforce enablement, and AI optimization, Merkle helps enterprises close the adoption gap and achieve sustained performance improvement from their content infrastructure.

Outcome	Why CSC Build Matters
KPI: Accelerated ROI Through Adoption	Effective adoption programs realize 143% of expected ROI versus 35% for poor adoption, achieving positive ROI within 6 to 8 months of engagement.
KPI: Platform Utilization Improvement	Drive 90%+ user adoption within the first 90 days through structured enablement, increasing platform utilization by 54% and reducing time to proficiency by 50%.
KPI: Continuous AI Optimization	Organizations actively optimizing AI-powered automation report 70% higher ROI while adapting to evolving technology capabilities.
KPI: Revenue Growth Enablement	Improved personalization at scale drives 10 to 15% uplift in revenue and conversion rates through more effective content targeting.

Content Supply Chain: Activate



Buyers and Industries

Understand our buyer and their motivation as well as the outcomes we deliver that help them meet their goals. Dive into industry-specific considerations.



PRIMARY AUDIENCE

VP of Marketing, VP of Digital Experiences, Director of IT

This buyer reports to the C-suite and is typically the decision maker requiring executive sign-off for optimization initiatives. They manage day-to-day content operations and experience firsthand the gap between platform capabilities and actual team usage. They are focused on making their teams more effective with the tools they already have.

Value realization

This buyer wants to see tangible value for their team from existing platform investments. How will adoption programs make their daily work more efficient? What measurable improvements can they expect?

Adoption

This buyer wants to understand how Merkle will enable their team to fully utilize platform capabilities. How do we overcome change resistance and build lasting proficiency?



PEERS AND INFLUENCERS

C-Suite, Marketing Operations Managers, Finance and Procurement

Decision makers at this level are influenced across many roles inside the organization. They require buy-in from peers and team members before making a final recommendation to the C-suite. Activate decisions are often evaluated against the sunk cost of existing platform investments.

Value Demonstration

Finance and Procurement want to understand the return on optimization investment relative to the original platform spend. Demonstrating value from existing assets is often easier to justify than new technology purchases.

Team Enablement

Marketing Managers need to know how their teams' daily workflows will change and what support they will receive during transition. They are often skeptical after previous change initiatives that failed to deliver lasting adoption.

Scalability

Marketing Operations Managers require assurance that optimization gains will scale across markets and teams without requiring proportional increases in support resources.



PART 4: TRAINING

Content Supply Chain: Activate

Commercial Guidance

The adoption gap problem (143% vs 35% ROI) represents a significant addressable market of organizations with existing platform investments.

Internal pricing slides for each engagement can be found on the following slides.



Key Competitors	Internal Teams and "Do Nothing" Clients often believe internal training teams can drive adoption or that "trying harder" will solve utilization problems. Without structured change management methodology and external accountability, internal efforts typically fail to sustain adoption gains beyond initial training periods.	Platform Vendor Professional Services <i>Adobe Professional Services, Salesforce Services, Sitecore Services??</i> Platform vendors offer implementation and basic enablement services but lack the business transformation expertise to drive enterprise-wide adoption. Their services focus on technical configuration rather than the change management, workflow redesign, and sustained optimization that deliver ROI.
	Consulting Firm Managed Services Arms <i>Accenture Song, Deloitte Digital, IBM iX, Publicis Sapient</i> These firms offer managed marketing services and content operations at scale, with strong technology partnerships and global delivery capabilities. However, their managed services models prioritize cost efficiency over adoption outcomes, often creating dependency rather than building internal capability. Merkle differentiates through adoption-first methodology that transfers knowledge and builds lasting proficiency.	Systems Integrators <i>Cognizant, Infosys, Wipro</i> SIs compete on price for ongoing platform support and maintenance. They excel at technical operations but lack the marketing domain expertise and change management capabilities required to drive adoption and demonstrate business value from content platforms.
Key Alliances	Adobe: Premier partner for Experience Cloud, Workfront, and GenStudio. Activate offerings leverage Adobe's platform capabilities for workflow optimization and AI-powered content production. Digital Adoption and Agentic Platforms: Gradiant (agentic AI for content supply chain automation, integrates with Adobe Experience Manager and Workfront), WalkMe (enterprise-grade digital adoption with AI-powered guidance), Whatfix (in-app guidance and workflow support), and Pendo (product analytics and adoption tracking). These platforms accelerate user proficiency and provide adoption measurement critical to Activate outcomes. dentsu Measurement Tools: AI Neuro, CPAT, Performance Agent, and Taxonomy Suite provide performance intelligence that powers the Continuous Value Accelerator and demonstrates content ROI. Tag/dentsu Creative Services: Managed Content Production offering leverages dentsu's global production network for clients seeking fully outsourced content operations.	

PART 4: TRAINING

Content Supply Chain: Activate



Why Merkle

Merkle is uniquely positioned to help our clients thrive and win in the current landscape. Understand how the Merkle story resonates in this context and grab relevant case studies.

OUR STORY: KEY DIFFERENTIATORS

Merkle is the transformation consultancy that speaks both IT and Marketing. Unlike system integrators, we are business value marketers first and technologists second, understanding what drives real adoption rather than just platform deployment. Unlike traditional agencies, we bring enterprise AI rigor and proven transformation methodology they cannot match. With 1,300+ Adobe-specialized employees and adoption-first approaches, we close the gap between platform investment and value realization.

Adoption-First Methodology: We embed change management from day one, driving 90%+ adoption within 90 days and reducing time to proficiency by 50%.

Integrated Experience Consultancy: As part of dentsu, we uniquely combine Merkle's technology depth with Tag's global production and dentsu's media and creative resources.

Regulated Industry Expertise: Deep experience with pharmaceutical, financial services, and CPG clients means we understand compliance-aware adoption that general consultancies overlook.

OUR WORK

Client	Project	Market	Description	Link to case
Lumen	Accelerating Engagement and Growth with a Modern Content Supply Chain	AMER	With the right strategies, data integration, and implementation support, Lumen now has a clear pathway for advanced personalization and industry leadership. They're ready to deliver the seamless, modern experiences B2B buyers now expect, with a solid foundation to innovate for B2B needs of the future.	LINK
Adobe AOR	Drive transformation through an adaptive end-to-end Content Supply Chain Solution	AMER	We integrated Adobe's marketing technology stack to create GenStudio dentsu+, a unified content supply chain solution ecosystem. Uncovering 110 optimization opportunities and proposed an integrated workflow and roadmap to automate and enable scalable personalization.	LINK

MARKET VALIDATION

Analyst	Report Name	Ranking Name	Year
Gartner	Magic Quadrant for Digital Experience Services	Leader	November 2024
IDC	MarketScape: Worldwide Adobe Experience Cloud Professional Services 2024-2025	Leader	2024-2025
Everest Group	Content Supply Chain Services PEAK Matrix	Leader	Copy



PART 4: TRAINING

Content Supply Chain: Activate



Sales Guidance

Help selling through the offering, from handling objections to understanding similar/competitive offerings where they exist.

GUIDANCE AND GUIDELINES

CSC Activate targets clients with existing platform investments that are not delivering expected value. The differentiator is adoption and operationalization, not more technology.

Platform Value realization is the wedge for post-implementation struggles. Position as operational rescue, not consulting.

Managed Content Production is cross-dentsu (DC, Tag, Media). Engage partners early when clients signal outsourcing interest.

Watch for expansion: Platform Value realization often leads to Continuous Value Accelerator; both can lead to Managed Content Production or back to Build.

WHAT TO LISTEN FOR

Concerns around platform investments not delivering promised ROI or where adoption has stalled post-implementation.

Frustration that teams have reverted to manual processes and workarounds despite significant technology investments.

Pressure from leadership to justify platform spend or demonstrate measurable business outcomes.

- **Client need 1:** "We spent millions on this platform and teams still use the old way."
- **Client need 2:** "Our vendor said go-live was successful, but nothing has changed."
- **Client need 3:** "We cannot prove ROI on our content technology investment."
- **Client need 4:** "We need help running this, not building more."

QUALIFYING QUESTIONS

- When did your content platform go live, and how would you rate adoption today?
- What percentage of your teams actively use the platform versus working around it?
- How do you currently measure ROI on your content technology investments?
- What happened after your implementation partner transitioned off?
- Are there specific workflows or capabilities that never gained traction?
- Do you have internal resources dedicated to platform optimization and adoption?
- What is your appetite for outsourcing content operations versus building internal capability?
- How is leadership measuring success of your content technology investment?
- What would need to change for your platform investment to be considered successful?
- Are there AI or automation features you implemented but cannot operationalize?
- How do you currently connect content performance data to creative decisions?
- Is there executive sponsorship for a multi-year optimization program?

PART 4: PRICING

Content Supply Chain: Activate



Levels of Engagement – Definition and Examples

BRONZE – TEAM / COLLABORATIVE

A Bronze engagement focuses on enabling a single team through targeted technology enablement or an Innovation Accelerator. It helps teams work more collaboratively and transparently by activating specific capabilities, improving visibility into work, and validating value quickly within a well-defined scope.

Example: *the Web team needs a central way to manage their work instead of working through email and chat tools for their creative development direction, reviews, approvals, and staging for publication.*

SILVER – ORGANIZATION / CROSS-FUNCTIONAL

A Silver engagement extends enablement across multiple teams or functions to drive alignment and consistency. It focuses on standardizing processes, improving cross-functional collaboration, and establishing lightweight governance to support shared outcomes and operational efficiency.

Example: *a campaign is launching and needs support from advertising, social, media, web, retail, CRM, etc. to uniformly execute on the briefed initiative.*

GOLD – ENTERPRISE / CROSS-ORGANIZATIONAL

A Gold engagement supports enterprise-wide transformation by connecting strategy and execution across business units. It aligns platforms, processes, and governance at scale to maximize enterprise value, improve decision-making, and establish a sustainable foundation for ongoing transformation.

Example: *The business development organization needs input and collaboration with marketing, retail organization, legal compliance, corp comm, and events to support a national Lunar New Year initiative.*

		BRONZE – Team/Pilot	SILVER – Department	GOLD – Enterprise
ENGAGEMENT MODEL	Discovery	Rapid health check; environment scan & workflow health assessment.	Targeted discovery, usage analytics, priority workflows.	Comprehensive discovery; end-to-end process mapping, adoption diagnostics.
	Timeframe	2-week discovery; 2-3 months of stabilization activities	3-week discovery; 5 months stabilization + guided handoff	4-week discovery; 7 months stabilization + adoption practices
	Client Engagement	Client – Team/Pilot ➡ Reactive support with scheduled touch-points (monthly). ➡ 2–4 interviews	Client – Department ➡ Consultative partnership with bi-weekly working sessions. ➡ 5–7 stakeholder interviews	Client – Enterprise ➡ Embedded leadership with weekly steering + working sessions + office hours. ➡ 10+ cross-functional interviews
	Collaboration	Tech Strategy, CX&C, CXM (2 offshore) Merkle advises & executes; Client hands-on tests & signs off	Tech Strategy, CX&C, CXM (3 onshore & offshore) Merkle advises & executes; Client hands-on tests & signs off	Tech Strategy, CX&C, CXM (5 onshore & offshore) Merkle advises & executes; Client hands-on tests & signs off Engaged Champion network & Governing committee
	Deliverables:	1. Current state workflow & usage heatmap 2. Use-case scorecard (3-5) 3. Stabilization Checklist (3-5) 4. Updated design documents 5. Static training documents & 1-2 Quick Reference Guides 6. Governance Model (if needed)	1. Current state workflow & usage and adoption heatmap 2. Use-case scorecard (6-9) 3. Stabilization Checklist (6-9) 4. Prioritized reconfiguration backlog 5. Updated design documents 6. Training & Adoption plan 7. Guided trainings documents, 1-3 Reference Guides (Incl. Recordings) 8. Governance Model & Champions	1. Current state workflow & usage and adoption heatmap 2. Use-case scorecard (10+) 3. Stabilization Checklist (10+) 4. Prioritized & sequenced reconfiguration backlog 5. Updated design documents & adoption plan 6. Training & Adoption plan (Incl. Comms Plan) 7. Facilitated live trainings calls & 2-5 training guides 8. Governance Model, Champions & Board practices 9. Office hours & a triage runbook
SCOPE	Resources	Strategy Lead – .5 Strategy Manager – 1 BSA Architect (CX&C) – 1 Developer II – 1	Strategy Lead – .5 Strategy Manager – .5 BSA Architect (CX&C) – 1 System Architect – 1 Developer II – 1 Change Manager (Light/Advisory)– .5	Program Lead (xxx) Strategy Lead – .5 Analytics Lead (CXM I&A) – .5 Strategy Manager – 1 Strategy Analyst - 1 BSA Architect (CX&C) – 1 System Architect – 1 Developer II – 2 Change Manager (Full-Service) – 1
	Duration	3 to 5 months at a minimum	6 to 8 months at a minimum	8 to 10 months at a minimum
	Cost	\$ 375,000+	\$ 500,000+	\$ 800,000+
SUPP ORT	Warranty/ Postlaunch	30-day post email support	45-day post email + monthly check-ins support on remediated workflows	60-day post support with embedded advisor + bi-weekly optimization sessions
	Next Sale	Continuous Value Accelerator	Continuous Value Accelerator	Enterprise Transformation (Build)

Continuous Value Accelerator

* All deliverables are PowerPoint format, unless noted.

	BRONZE	SILVER	GOLD
Discovery	STABILIZATION Rapid assessment (2 weeks) covering current platform utilization, basic workflow analysis, and key stakeholder interviews across 2-3 business units	CONSULTATIVE OPTIMIZATION Comprehensive assessment (4 weeks) including detailed workflow mapping, stakeholder interviews across all business units, technology integration analysis, and AI readiness evaluation	LED VALUE realization Deep enterprise assessment (6-8 weeks) including comprehensive stakeholder engagement across all markets/regions, competitive benchmarking, advanced AI capability assessment, integration architecture review, and strategic alignment workshops
Timeframe	6 months	12 months	18-24 months
Client Engagement	Monthly steering committee meetings, bi-weekly progress reviews	Weekly leadership reviews, monthly steering committee, quarterly business reviews with C-suite	Weekly executive steering committee, bi-weekly cross-functional working sessions, monthly board-level reporting, quarterly strategic planning sessions
Collaboration	Client provides platform access, 2-3 dedicated resources part-time, basic training participation	Client provides dedicated PMO liaison, 4-6 resources across functions, executive sponsorship, comprehensive training participation	Full client PMO establishment, 8-12 dedicated resources, C-suite championship, global stakeholder participation, comprehensive change management program
Deliverables:	1. Platform optimization roadmap 2. Basic performance analytics dashboard 3. Standard governance framework 4. User training program (foundation level)Quarterly performance reports	1. Enterprise adoption program 2. Advanced performance analytics dashboard with predictive insights 3. PMO governance framework with cross-functional workflows 4. AI enhancement plan and implementation 5. Continuous optimization roadmap with quarterly milestones 6. Knowledge transfer documentation	1. Complete enterprise adoption program with global rollout 2. Real-time performance analytics with AI-driven insights and predictive modeling 3. Advanced PMO governance framework with global standardization 4. Comprehensive AI enhancement plan with emerging technology roadmap 5. Multi-year continuous optimization strategy 6. Center of Excellence establishment and internal capability building 7. Knowledge transfer and certification programs 8. Competitive intelligence and market adaptation framework
Resources	1 Engagement Manager, 1 Platform Specialist, 1 Change Management Consultant, 1 Analytics Specialist	1 Engagement Director, 2 Platform Specialists, 1 AI/Automation Expert, 2 Change Management Consultants, 1 Analytics Specialist	1 Client Partner, 1 Engagement Director, 3 Platform Specialists, 2 AI/Automation Experts, 3 Change Management Consultants, 2 Analytics Specialists, 1 Strategic Advisor
Duration	6 Months implementation + 3 Months optimization	12 Months Implementation + 6 Months Optimization & Knowledge Transfer	18-24 Months
Cost	\$ 150K - \$ 400+K	\$ 500K - \$ 850K+	\$ 1M – \$2M+
Warranty/ Postlaunch	60 days post-launch support, monthly check-ins for 3 months	90 days full support, bi-weekly check-ins for 6 months, quarterly strategic reviews for 1 year	6 months full support, monthly strategic reviews for 12 months, quarterly advisory sessions for 24 months, priority access to emerging capabilities



